

# National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey

## August 2021-August 2023 Data Documentation, Codebook, and Frequencies

### Mental Health - Depression Screener (DPQ\_L)

**Data File:** DPQ\_L.xpt

**First Published:** September 2024

**Last Revised:** NA

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## Component Description

A nine-item depression screening questionnaire (variable name prefix DPQ), called the Patient Health Questionnaire (also, PHQ-9), (Kroenke and Spitzer, 2002; Kroenke et. al., 2001) was administered to determine the frequency of depression symptoms over the past 2 weeks. For each symptom question, scores ranging from 0 to 3, are associated with the response categories "not at all," "several days," "more than half the days," and "nearly every day." An additional functional impairment question is asked if any symptom is endorsed. This screening instrument incorporates DSM-IV depression diagnostic criteria (Spitzer et. al., 1999).

## Eligible Sample

Participants aged 12 years and older who were able to understand and read English or Spanish were eligible. The interview was not administered to participants needing a proxy informant or interpreter due to the sensitive nature of the questions. Only data from participants aged 18 and older are included in this data file. Data for youth 12-17 years of age are available through the NCHS Research Data Center.

## Interview Setting and Mode of Administration

The questions were asked at the Mobile Examination Center (MEC) using the Audio Computer-Assisted Personal Interview (ACASI) system. In previous NHANES, these questions were administered as part of the face-to-face MEC Interview.

## Quality Assurance & Quality Control

The ACASI system is programmed with built-in consistency checks to reduce data entry errors.

## Data Processing and Editing

Edits were made to ensure completeness, consistency, and analytic usefulness of the data.

## Analytic Notes

A total score, ranging from 0 to 27, can be calculated for participants who have complete responses to the symptom questions. Major depression and depression severity can be assessed using pre-defined cut-points, described in the references.

Please refer to the [NHANES Analytic Guidelines](#) and the on-line [NHANES Tutorial](#) for further details on the use of sample weights and other analytic issues.

## References

- Kroenke K, Spitzer RL, Williams JB. The PHQ-9: validity of a brief depression severity measure. *J Gen Intern Med* 2001; 16: 1606-13.
- Kroenke K, Spitzer RL. The PHQ-9: a new depression and diagnostic severity measure. *Psych Annals* 2002; 32:509-21.
- Spitzer RL, Kroenke K, Williams JB. Validation and utility of a self-report version of Prime MD: the PHQ primary care study. *JAMA* 1999; 282: 1737-44.

## Codebook and Frequencies

### SEQN - Respondent sequence number

|                       |                                             |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>Variable Name:</b> | SEQN                                        |
| <b>SAS Label:</b>     | Respondent sequence number                  |
| <b>English Text:</b>  | Respondent sequence number.                 |
| <b>Target:</b>        | Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS |

## DPQ010 - Have little interest in doing things

**Variable Name:** DPQ010

**SAS Label:** Have little interest in doing things

**English Text:** Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems: little interest or pleasure in doing things? Would you say...

**Target:** Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

| Code or Value | Value Description       | Count | Cumulative | Skip to Item |
|---------------|-------------------------|-------|------------|--------------|
| 0             | Not at all              | 3703  | 3703       |              |
| 1             | Several days            | 1205  | 4908       |              |
| 2             | More than half the days | 334   | 5242       |              |
| 3             | Nearly every day        | 256   | 5498       |              |
| 7             | Refused                 | 5     | 5503       |              |
| 9             | Don't know              | 16    | 5519       |              |
| .             | Missing                 | 818   | 6337       |              |

## DPQ020 - Feeling down, depressed, or hopeless

**Variable Name:** DPQ020

**SAS Label:** Feeling down, depressed, or hopeless

**English Text:** [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] feeling down, depressed, or hopeless?

**Target:** Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

| Code or Value | Value Description       | Count | Cumulative | Skip to Item |
|---------------|-------------------------|-------|------------|--------------|
| 0             | Not at all              | 3674  | 3674       |              |
| 1             | Several days            | 1325  | 4999       |              |
| 2             | More than half the days | 295   | 5294       |              |
| 3             | Nearly every day        | 214   | 5508       |              |
| 7             | Refused                 | 3     | 5511       |              |
| 9             | Don't know              | 7     | 5518       |              |
| .             | Missing                 | 819   | 6337       |              |

## DPQ030 - Trouble sleeping or sleeping too much

**Variable Name:** DPQ030

**SAS Label:** Trouble sleeping or sleeping too much

**English Text:** [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] trouble falling or staying asleep, or sleeping too much?

**Target:** Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

| Code or Value | Value Description       | Count | Cumulative | Skip to Item |
|---------------|-------------------------|-------|------------|--------------|
| 0             | Not at all              | 2772  | 2772       |              |
| 1             | Several days            | 1690  | 4462       |              |
| 2             | More than half the days | 511   | 4973       |              |
| 3             | Nearly every day        | 536   | 5509       |              |
| 7             | Refused                 | 3     | 5512       |              |
| 9             | Don't know              | 4     | 5516       |              |
| .             | Missing                 | 821   | 6337       |              |

## DPQ040 - Feeling tired or having little energy

**Variable Name:** DPQ040

**SAS Label:** Feeling tired or having little energy

**English Text:** [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] feeling tired or having little energy?

**Target:** Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

| Code or Value | Value Description       | Count | Cumulative | Skip to Item |
|---------------|-------------------------|-------|------------|--------------|
| 0             | Not at all              | 2348  | 2348       |              |
| 1             | Several days            | 2113  | 4461       |              |
| 2             | More than half the days | 571   | 5032       |              |
| 3             | Nearly every day        | 474   | 5506       |              |
| 7             | Refused                 | 3     | 5509       |              |
| 9             | Don't know              | 5     | 5514       |              |
| .             | Missing                 | 823   | 6337       |              |

## DPQ050 - Poor appetite or overeating

**Variable Name:** DPQ050

**SAS Label:** Poor appetite or overeating

**English Text:** [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] poor appetite or overeating?

**Target:** Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

| Code or Value | Value Description       | Count | Cumulative | Skip to Item |
|---------------|-------------------------|-------|------------|--------------|
| 0             | Not at all              | 3710  | 3710       |              |
| 1             | Several days            | 1138  | 4848       |              |
| 2             | More than half the days | 371   | 5219       |              |
| 3             | Nearly every day        | 291   | 5510       |              |
| 7             | Refused                 | 0     | 5510       |              |
| 9             | Don't know              | 3     | 5513       |              |
| .             | Missing                 | 824   | 6337       |              |



## DPQ060 - Feeling bad about yourself

**Variable Name:** DPQ060

**SAS Label:** Feeling bad about yourself

**English Text:** [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] feeling bad about yourself - or that you are a failure or have let yourself or your family down?

**Target:** Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

| Code or Value | Value Description       | Count | Cumulative | Skip to Item |
|---------------|-------------------------|-------|------------|--------------|
| 0             | Not at all              | 3971  | 3971       |              |
| 1             | Several days            | 1054  | 5025       |              |
| 2             | More than half the days | 268   | 5293       |              |
| 3             | Nearly every day        | 212   | 5505       |              |
| 7             | Refused                 | 3     | 5508       |              |
| 9             | Don't know              | 2     | 5510       |              |
| .             | Missing                 | 827   | 6337       |              |

## DPQ070 - Trouble concentrating on things

**Variable Name:** DPQ070

**SAS Label:** Trouble concentrating on things

**English Text:** [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] trouble concentrating on things, such as reading the newspaper or watching TV?

**Target:** Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

| Code or Value | Value Description       | Count | Cumulative | Skip to Item |
|---------------|-------------------------|-------|------------|--------------|
| 0             | Not at all              | 4036  | 4036       |              |
| 1             | Several days            | 989   | 5025       |              |
| 2             | More than half the days | 277   | 5302       |              |
| 3             | Nearly every day        | 203   | 5505       |              |
| 7             | Refused                 | 2     | 5507       |              |
| 9             | Don't know              | 1     | 5508       |              |
| .             | Missing                 | 829   | 6337       |              |

**DPQ080 - Moving or speaking slowly or too fast****Variable Name:** DPQ080**SAS Label:** Moving or speaking slowly or too fast**English Text:** [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] moving or speaking so slowly that other people could have noticed? Or the opposite - being so fidgety or restless that you have been moving around a lot more than usual?**Target:** Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

| Code or Value | Value Description       | Count | Cumulative | Skip to Item |
|---------------|-------------------------|-------|------------|--------------|
| 0             | Not at all              | 4748  | 4748       |              |
| 1             | Several days            | 511   | 5259       |              |
| 2             | More than half the days | 129   | 5388       |              |
| 3             | Nearly every day        | 108   | 5496       |              |
| 7             | Refused                 | 4     | 5500       |              |
| 9             | Don't know              | 8     | 5508       |              |
| .             | Missing                 | 829   | 6337       |              |

**DPQ090 - Thought you would be better off dead****Variable Name:** DPQ090**SAS Label:** Thought you would be better off dead**English Text:** [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] Thoughts that you would be better off dead or of hurting yourself in some way?**Target:** Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

| Code or Value | Value Description       | Count | Cumulative | Skip to Item |
|---------------|-------------------------|-------|------------|--------------|
| 0             | Not at all              | 5207  | 5207       |              |
| 1             | Several days            | 209   | 5416       |              |
| 2             | More than half the days | 57    | 5473       |              |
| 3             | Nearly every day        | 28    | 5501       |              |
| 7             | Refused                 | 0     | 5501       |              |
| 9             | Don't know              | 5     | 5506       |              |
| .             | Missing                 | 831   | 6337       |              |

## DPQ100 - Difficulty these problems have caused

**Variable Name:** DPQ100

**SAS Label:** Difficulty these problems have caused

**English Text:** How difficult have these problems made it for you to do your work, take care of things at home, or get along with people?

**Target:** Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

| Code or Value | Value Description    | Count | Cumulative | Skip to Item |
|---------------|----------------------|-------|------------|--------------|
| 0             | Not at all difficult | 2573  | 2573       |              |
| 1             | Somewhat difficult   | 1306  | 3879       |              |
| 2             | Very difficult       | 207   | 4086       |              |
| 3             | Extremely difficult  | 74    | 4160       |              |
| 7             | Refused              | 4     | 4164       |              |
| 9             | Don't know           | 3     | 4167       |              |
| .             | Missing              | 2170  | 6337       |              |